Foreign control and lobbying disclosure: pilot findings

7 October 2026 · Private research, not a finding of misconduct

The strongest lead is an apparent LDA ownership-disclosure inconsistency involving Stark Aerospace. This pilot does not establish deliberate concealment, a FARA violation, or an obscured campaign meeting its $1 million definition of "major." Two related follow-up questions emerged from original ownership records. Jev ranked all three, but its assessments required substantial correction and did not outperform the source-based rules consistently.

The work starts with the repository's X04 source-pair card, recovered through the supplied inventory, and the user's quoted item 10. The attached *Investigative reporting opportunities(2).pdf* could be identified in Library but its supported transfer returned HTTP 403; its item 10 was not read. No bypass was attempted. This limitation does not affect the independently retrieved filings below.

Ranked follow-up list

This is **Jev's comparative ordering**, not a ranking of guilt. The editorial disposition separates evidence from the model's output.

Jev rank	Client and engagement	What merits follow-up	2025 LDA income in acquired reports	Editorial disposition
1	Stark Aerospace — Bramer Group; Emanuel & Associates	Two original LD1s check "No" foreign entity; original financial statements bracket their dates with 100% IAI equity/voting interests	$136,500 across these two firms	Strongest documentary lead; exact-day chain and explanation still needed
2	Israel Aerospace Industries N.A. — Emanuel & Associates	A 2024 update names the corporate parent; apparent ultimate-state-parent omission merits checking	$24,000	Weaker, unresolved chain question; foreign ownership was disclosed
3	ELTA North America — CR Federal	Original LD1 checks "No"; IAI statements list a wholly owned same-named subsidiary	$87,500 to less than $92,500	Concrete lead, but legal-entity bridge and exact-day ownership remain incomplete

1. Stark Aerospace. Bramer's LD1, section 14 was posted 14 August 2024, effective 1 June 2024. Emanuel's LD1, section 14 was posted 20 October 2025, effective 1 June 2025. Both original HTML checkbox states say no qualifying foreign entity. Client IDs differ by filing relationship (61125 and 69451); matching names and Columbus, Mississippi street addresses bridge them, rather than an assumption that database client IDs are universal corporate identifiers. Emanuel identifies missile-defense and unmanned-aerial-system issues.

GlobalPoint's FARA Exhibit A, filed 12 December 2025, physical pages 1 and 5, identifies the same Stark client/address and states IAI/state ownership. The attached contract identifies the chain **Stark → IAI North America → Israel Aerospace Industries**, gives a November 2025–April 2026 term, and bears 7 November signatures (pages 12 and 17). Its $270,000 fee plus up to $100,000 reimbursable expenses is a contractual commitment, not verified receipts. Pages 11 and 18 describe government and media outreach benefiting IAI and Stark. GlobalPoint is a separate registrant with a separate engagement; it must not be substituted for either LDA firm.

The decisive chronological improvement came from IAI's 2024 financial statements, Note 11(c), printed page 54 / PDF page 55, an original company report available through Germany's lobbying register. Its table records 100% equity and voting interests in Stark at both 31 December 2023 and 2024. The 2025 statements, same note and printed page repeat that interest for 2024 and 2025. These snapshots bracket the registrations; they are not a daily share register. The 2024 table was also visually checked against the downloaded PDF.

Best innocent explanation: a filing mistake or misunderstanding of indirect ownership, rather than intentional concealment. Different services could explain the choice of LDA versus FARA, but do not by themselves resolve an LDA ownership checkbox. **Decisive missing record:** the contemporaneous intermediate share register/transaction chronology, followed by the filers' explanation and any correction indexed under another alias. No outreach occurred.

2. IAI North America / Emanuel. The 2024 first-quarter amendment, section 27, posted 22 April, identifies Israel Aircraft Industries at 100% ownership and zero contribution. The preceding report already named that parent; this amendment is not evidence of its first disclosure. No "State of Israel" text was found in the 56 acquired Israel Aerospace history-query originals. That bounded observation raises an ultimate-parent question, not a claim that all foreign control was hidden. The Aircraft/Aerospace naming history and exact client identity require authoritative bridging. **Best innocent explanation:** incomplete understanding of the indirect chain or a record outside the tested alias. **Missing:** dated chain and corporate name-change record. Jev ranked this second; the editor considers the explicit ELTA "No" a clearer follow-up trigger, subject to identity verification.

3. ELTA North America / CR Federal. The LD1, section 14 was posted 3 April 2025, effective 1 March, client 65440, defense activity. It checks "No." The IAI ownership table supplies the dated group interest. A company product sheet, page 2, dated September 2021 corroborates the Annapolis Junction address, with Henkels/Henkles spelling variation. It does not supply a legal registration number. No ELTA FARA Exhibit A was acquired: this is an ownership-led expansion from the original collision. **Best innocent explanation:** filing error, entity mismatch, or misunderstood ownership after security mitigation. A company statement about FOCI mitigation does not show that equity ownership ended. **Missing:** legal-entity identifier and dated share chain. The fourth-quarter original, section 12 checks less than $5,000; its null API amount is not zero.

What the controls ruled out

Pillsbury's IAI North America LD1, posted 8 October 2024 names both IAI Ltd and the State of Israel at 100%, with zero contributions. Blank foreign-entity **additions** in subsequent quarterly reports are not evidence of nondisclosure. Its $480,000 reported 2025 income is separately attributed, not added to Stark's campaign.

Haiti and Congo substring matches proved to be different named clients when original LDA client fields were retrieved. Harena's Exhibit A and a March 2026 contract amendment supplied no contradictory same-client LDA pair. A mining company acquiring a project is not evidence that someone acquired the company. A September 2025 GlobalPoint amendment concerned a Côte d'Ivoire party, not Stark. Shared registrants, countries and similar names are inadequate joins.

Coverage and limits

The deliberately bounded discovery cohort contains **19 indexed 2025 FARA Exhibit A/B documents**, discovered through corporate-ownership search phrases plus three government access controls; 15 originals were readable through browser PDF extraction and four were inaccessible. The corporate principals read were Stark and Harena. Ten government/government-intermediary and three individual records provided exclusion controls. A source-led expansion followed the US subsidiaries named in IAI's ownership table rather than selecting famous names.

The pipeline completed **28 paginated LDA name/history queries**, retrieving **189 distinct catalog filings**, and downloaded **149 LDA originals**. Of these, **137 cover every result in the four corporate history queries** (Stark 13; ELTA 6; IAI North America 62; Israel Aerospace 56); 12 further originals test country-name joins. Two FARA amendments were read in addition to the frozen cohort. All figures describe acquired coverage, not the full lobbying universe. An initial unfiltered API access probe is excluded. Exact queries and every cohort disposition appear in the annex and machine-readable files.

“Major” means at least **$1 million in a calendar year of attributable, nonduplicated LDA outside-firm income or in-house expenses**, assessed separately. This operational threshold was chosen during the pilot, not preregistered. None of the three leads meets it on acquired evidence. Broader significance may warrant reporting, but procurement awards, full-term contract ceilings, group-wide spending and foreign funding are different measures. Overall campaign spending remains incomplete.

The declared search cohort and its ownership-led expansion have been screened. The stopping constraint is evidence access/completeness, not money: bulk FARA downloads and direct PDFs returned 403, four cohort originals remained unavailable, and exact-day private ownership records and a certified full FARA amendment history were not obtained. Search-engine indexing cannot certify completeness. Broader national coverage would require a new acquisition design; this is not an incidence estimate.

What Jev added—and failed to add

Jev assessed every frozen-cohort dossier, all three leads and the real negative control, with source citations, identity, chronology, disclosure, materiality, innocent explanation, missing-record and abstention questions. Three evidence stages and comparative ranking are retained. Final ordering: **Stark, IAI/Emanuel, ELTA**.

Its useful contribution was cheap structured review and repeated identification of the dated share register as decisive. Its weaknesses were substantive: it called the initial later-only Stark evidence a mismatch; kept Haiti at medium even after rejecting the identity join; and assigned medium follow-up to the already-disclosed Pillsbury negative control. Final answers still combine “control not established” with “documentary mismatch” for two cases. Those are caution flags, not proof. The code-only baseline, using the same human-audited facts, was more consistent on the negative controls. This small, selected evaluation does **not** establish general accuracy or incremental discovery value.

Eight synthetic controls passed after one failed formulation was revised from a compound legal judgment to literal extraction; both attempts are retained. This is prompt calibration, not a clean held-out accuracy test. Eight offline budget/client tests passed. Source retrieval, joins, chronology, deduplication and spending enforcement used ordinary code; Jev neither browsed nor supplied new facts.

Spending: 42 successful Jev requests; conservatively rounded usage-based estimate **$0.002858**, not a provider invoice. Even retaining the full $0.003 reservation for every request would total **$0.126**. The new authorization was $15, with an internal $14 cap; previous pilot spending is separate. No other paid provider was used. Weekly usage was user-reported as 90% remaining; no telemetry or depletion attribution is available.

Read TECHNICAL-ANNEX.md for rules, reproducibility and audit details; filing-index.csv for original filing links; cohort.json for all FARA IDs; and spending-summary.json for the accounting summary.

Technical annex

Legal and temporal matrix

Issue	Rule applied	Primary source and temporal scope
LDA foreign owner	Section 1603(b)(4): identify qualifying foreign entity, including at least 20% equitable ownership; control and interested-affiliate alternatives also matter. Contribution amount reporting is separate; a zero contribution does not erase ownership identification.	2024 US Code, 2 USC 1603, subsection (b)(4); acquired original LD1 section 14 repeats the alternatives
Indirect chain	Joint guidance's wholly owned chain example requires foreign parents up the chain; the guidance is advisory, not a judicial ruling. Do not confuse domestic subsidiary with ultimate foreign owner.	Joint LDA guidance, registration section, foreign entities; revision 28 February 2025. Statutory rule also checked in 2024 edition; no new 2025 rule is retroactively assumed
Registration thresholds	2021–24: firm income $3,000 per client/quarter; in-house expenses $14,000. From 1 January 2025: $3,500/$16,000. These exemptions do not change the 20% ownership threshold. LDA lobbyist/contact/time tests also apply.	House historical notices, March 2021 and January 2025 notices; Senate thresholds
Updates	Quarterly reports include changes to registration information; LD2 new-entity fields are not a fresh denial of the original disclosure. Registrations, amendments, additions and removals must be read as chronology.	2 USC 1604(b)(1), 2024; original LD2 sections 27/28
FARA Exhibit A/B	Exhibit A identifies each nonexempt foreign principal; B records agreements. Changes to exhibits within 10 days are addressed by **28 CFR 5.201(b)**. Section 5.208 does not supply this deadline. Exhibit C under 5.201(c) concerns the registrant, not an automatic ownership register for every principal.	2025 annual CFR, Part 5, 5.201, 5.208–.209; actual acquired forms revision 10/23

Issue	Rule applied	Primary source and temporal scope
FARA exemptions	Section 5.304(b)/(c) makes commercial exemptions activity-specific; government ownership alone does not decide all conditions. Under 5.307 the LDA exemption does not apply when a foreign government/party is the principal beneficiary. No entity-wide exemption conclusion is made.	Same annual CFR; DOJ FARA FAQ. Proposed 2025 regulatory revisions are not treated as enacted rules

The pilot assesses 2024–25 documentary questions. Older LDA records are historical-chain retrievals; it makes no liability claim under pre-2008 thresholds. Financial statements dated March 2025/2026 describe earlier year ends. They provide retrospective source evidence, not proof that a filer saw them when filing. The English IAI statements are a convenience translation; the Hebrew version is authoritative. No daily share-register continuity has been independently certified.

Acquisition and cohort definition

Repository start: research/2026-10-04/consequential-expansion-09/START-HERE.md, baseline c29762cac5f31aa5b7886da446f3f6647288ddfb; recovered X04 formulation in source-card.json. Initial checkout 218de208...; separate branch research/lobbying-control-pilot-20261007; checkpoint d4e63f0. Prior sanctions guard and tests were read from remote commit 0edf7130942e817c12b7a23d7d0f9038ed74ec11, not assumed present locally. No relevant .agents/skills files were available. Unrelated repository content was preserved.

First ownership searches (verbatim):

- site:efile.fara.gov/docs/ "Exhibit-AB-2025" "Corporation" "owns"

- site:efile.fara.gov/docs/ "Exhibit-AB-2025" "wholly"

- site:efile.fara.gov/docs/ "Exhibit-AB-2025" "shareholders"

Expansion searches (verbatim):

- site:efile.fara.gov/docs/ "2025" "Exhibit A" "wholly-owned subsidiary"

- site:efile.fara.gov/docs/ "2025" "Exhibit A" "shareholders are"

- site:efile.fara.gov/docs/ "2025" "Exhibit A" "percent owned"

These searches yielded nine initial and seven further unique documents, plus three earlier government access controls. cohort.json freezes the resulting 19, including four failed originals. Boilerplate “corporation” hits were retained as controls, not silently dropped. This is an indexed convenience cohort. The source card did not contain a prior original-filing cohort to reuse.

LDA client-name searches used every readable principal’s mapped query, plus Bulgaria/Rwanda aliases and auxiliary blocked-document candidate searches (Apex, Havas, Qatar Investment, Romanian-American). Those candidate names are not promoted to verified FARA identities. Ownership-driven expansion followed Stark’s IAI chain and the US subsidiaries named in IAI’s original table: ELTA North America and IAI North America/Israel Aerospace. All 28 exact parameter sets, counts and pagination endpoints are in sources/lda-*-summary.json. Four corporate history queries omit the year filter; others use 2025. next is followed because the server caps pages at 25 despite a request for 100.

Original HTML/PDF filings are saved under their UUIDs. Some .html files are PDFs because the server returned that original format; extraction checks magic bytes. filing-index.csv preserves registrant IDs, client IDs, original URLs, dates, periods and local paths. Name normalization never merges separate registrants. Different client IDs are not treated as different corporations without checking original addresses; shared names are not sufficient for merging.

Browser PDF extraction supplied FARA originals where executor requests were denied. It did not supply local PDF bytes or a visual checkbox inspection; FARA ownership interpretation uses the explicit narrative appendix. Browser search/open exports are partial provenance aids, not full original PDF archives. Manual dossier notes cite physical pages. The downloaded IAI 2024 report was text-extracted and visually checked on physical page 55; its hash is in source-hashes.json. Two HTTP-200 files (iai-2024-press.html, stark-ms2024.html) are challenge pages, **not verified originals**, and are excluded from evidence claims. The manifest records HTTP results, not evidentiary quality.

Pipeline and replay

From repository root, the following runs are offline and incur no charges:

```
python -m unittest discover -s research/2026-10-07/lobbying-control-pilot/scripts -p test_guard.py
python research/2026-10-07/lobbying-control-pilot/scripts/refine.py
python research/2026-10-07/lobbying-control-pilot/scripts/final_iteration.py
python research/2026-10-07/lobbying-control-pilot/scripts/summarize.py
```

refine.py first imports build_dossiers.py to rebuild the fixed initial dossiers, then adds audited second-pass findings. final_iteration.py adds the contract-chain/full-history evidence. These scripts preserve model outputs. summarize.py deduplicates UUIDs, selects the latest filing within registrant/client/year/quarter, excludes registrations from annual totals, retains missing values, and generates chronology/coverage/audit/spending files. complete_history.py is a free-network replay for the four acquired corporate queries, with four download workers. acquire.py provides bounded TLS-verified retrieval, immutable cache, source hashes and pagination. Search discovery is reproducible from saved queries/cohort, but search-engine rankings can change; it is not a deterministic national census.

The baseline in refine.py uses explicit audited flags: identity bridge, dated ownership evidence, original “No,” partial-chain question. It assigns high for supported explicit mismatches, medium for unresolved explicit/partial questions, low for no pair/already disclosed, and abstains for unavailable originals. Human extraction is an input to both baseline and Jev. It is not an autonomous information-extraction benchmark.

evaluate.py requires explicit --live; guard.py blocks live calls after jev/COMPLETE exists. Do not remove this sentinel or reset the ledger for a replay. Provider requests, raw responses, distributions, model version and observed token usage are archived. Do not interpret the model’s reported confidence as calibrated probability of wrongdoing.

Iteration audit

Stage	Added evidence/action	Result
Calibration	Eight synthetic tasks, including later acquisition, earlier disclosure, different client, funding confusion and document instructions	Initial compound positive control scored .78 against .80 threshold; stopped before cases. Rephrased as literal extraction scored .90. Earlier failed result retained. All final eight passed; this is tuned calibration
1	All 19 frozen dossiers; Stark initially later-only ownership	Jev overcalled Stark; raised Haiti/Congo despite unresolved identity; abstained on four unavailable originals
2	2023/24/25 ownership snapshots; ELTA original/address; IAI parent amendment and Pillsbury negative; Haiti/Congo originals; Harena amendment	Comparative order Stark, IAI/Emanuel, ELTA. Haiti remained medium; Pillsbury negative received medium despite already-disclosed finding

Stage	Added evidence/action	Result
3	All 137 corporate-history originals; Stark contract intermediate chain, signatures, scope and fees; unrelated GlobalPoint amendment rejected	Comparative order unchanged. Stark high; IAI/Emanuel high; ELTA medium. Exact-day control still marked not established. Editor retains qualified lead status, not model legal conclusions

Final Jev classification of “documentary mismatch” alongside “control not established” remains internally cautionary. jev/audit.json flags this mechanically. The model helped structure questions but did not discover the ownership document, improve the joins, or resolve the legal uncertainty. Extraction and source review drove the improvements. No held-out recall, precision or accuracy claim is justified by this small nonrandom cohort.

Spending enforcement

Only existing JEV_API_KEY/TYPESAFE_API_KEY integration was used; no keys were printed or saved. Current official model documentation and API documentation were checked before calls; authenticated model-list access succeeded. Pinned model jev-1.13.0; verified input price $0.042/million, free output, maximum 64,000-token context. Full-context input cost is $0.002688; each transaction first reserves $0.003. Bodies are capped at 16,000 bytes. SQLite BEGIN IMMEDIATE, durable reservations, no automatic retries/redirects, strict response/usage validation and retained uncertainty reservations enforce the bound. Eight offline tests cover these failure paths.

Total: 42 successful calls, including failed calibration wording, 19 first-stage dossiers, seven second-stage, three third-stage and four comparative choices. Usage-based rounded accounting: $0.002858. Maximum if every full reservation were retained: $0.126. Internal cap $14, authorized cap $15. No provider invoice was available. The inherited ledger schema mentions Exa in a generic note, but the guard allows only Jev and no Exa request was made.

Remaining evidence gaps

No certified FARA bulk corpus, complete principal-specific FARA amendment history, four blocked cohort originals, exact-day private share registers, or underlying LDA-firm instructions were acquired. Original corporate reports support year-end ownership, not intent. No response from any named party was sought because outreach was outside authorization. The report should not be published as an accusation.